

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Dr Afshan Jamil

Address: 15 Newbolt Avenue North Cheam SM3 8ED

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to express my support for Planning Application DM2025/01591. I have lived in Sutton for 14 years, I work locally as a GP, and I am also a parent of three teenagers who are growing up in this community.

Over the years, Sutton has been a place my family and I are proud to call home. However, I have increasingly seen, both professionally and personally, the shortage of accessible, affordable indoor community spaces. Many structured activities for young people, educational support sessions, and health-focused workshops rely on limited or costly venues. This proposal would help address that gap in a practical and proportionate way.

In my role as a GP, I regularly see the impact of social isolation, anxiety, low mood and lack of safe youth provision. Elderly residents struggling with loneliness, new parents needing support networks, and teenagers lacking structured engagement are common themes in primary care. Community hubs that promote connection, belonging and purposeful activity play a significant preventative role in supporting mental and physical wellbeing.

As a parent of three teenagers, I understand first-hand the importance of safe, local and supervised environments. There are currently no youth clubs in the immediate area. A managed space offering educational programmes, youth engagement, and positive social interaction would be of genuine benefit, not only to my own children, but to many local families.

I also particularly welcome the inclusion of dedicated space and activities for women, which are limited locally, especially culturally sensitive community-based wellbeing programmes.

From a planning perspective, the building is modest in scale and in keeping with the surrounding residential area. It represents a low-intensity use compared with other potential developments. The inclusion of 12 on-site parking spaces and 2 disabled bays, along with cycle racks, shows appropriate consideration for access and sustainable travel. The staggering of Friday prayers to avoid school pick-up times further demonstrates sensitivity to local traffic patterns. I therefore do not anticipate significant traffic, noise or light disturbance. The retention of greenery is also a positive aspect of the design.

Overall, I believe this proposal represents a thoughtful and much-needed community investment that will strengthen social cohesion and support preventative health and wellbeing in Sutton.

I respectfully ask the Council to approve this application.